PROJECT DOCUMENT

Mitsue Project

Impact at a Glance — for Philanthropists & Impact Investors

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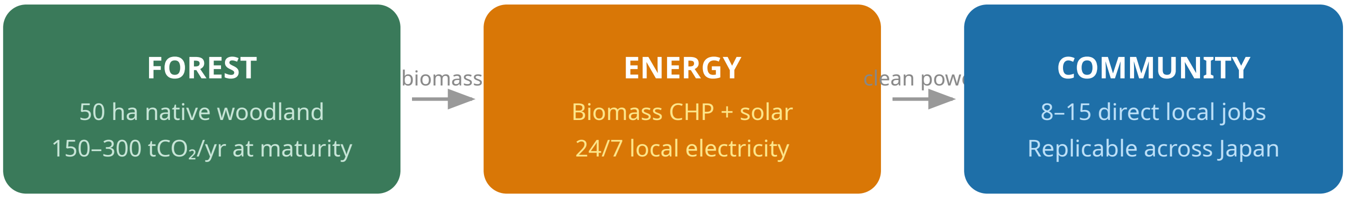
Mitsue Project — Impact at a Glance

Ecology · Energy · Digital Infrastructure for Rural Japan

A 25-year initiative in Mitsue Village, Nara Prefecture (御杖村)

The Story in One Flow



Aging cedar forest is thinned and converted to native broadleaf woodland. The thinnings fuel a biomass CHP plant, generating electricity and heat around the clock. That clean, local power runs a small AI data center — which provides the stable demand that makes the whole energy system economically viable — while the forest recovers, the wildlife returns, and the village gains jobs, income, and resilience it did not have before.

These three elements are not separate projects. Each one makes the other two possible.

Three Numbers That Tell the Story

Impact Area	What We Aim For	Why It Matters
🌲 **Forest Restored**	**50 hectares** of sugi monoculture converted to native mixed woodland over 25 years; first 5–10 ha within Phase 1–2	Sequesters **150–300 tCO_2 per year** at maturity; reverses biodiversity loss; keeps wildlife out of crop areas; generates J-Credit income for landowners
⚡ **Energy Generated**	**24/7 local electricity** from biomass CHP (sugi thinnings), complemented by rooftop solar and EV charging; exact kW sized in Phase 1 feasibility study	Powers the data center plus community facilities round-the-clock; eliminates grid dependency; keeps critical services running during blackouts; surplus sold back to grid
👥 **Community Impact**	**8–15 direct local jobs** by Year 5 (forestry, operations, maintenance, administration); income for forest landowners from Year 2; open model for replication	Reverses rural depopulation; creates self-sustaining local economy; everything is documented openly so other villages can replicate it

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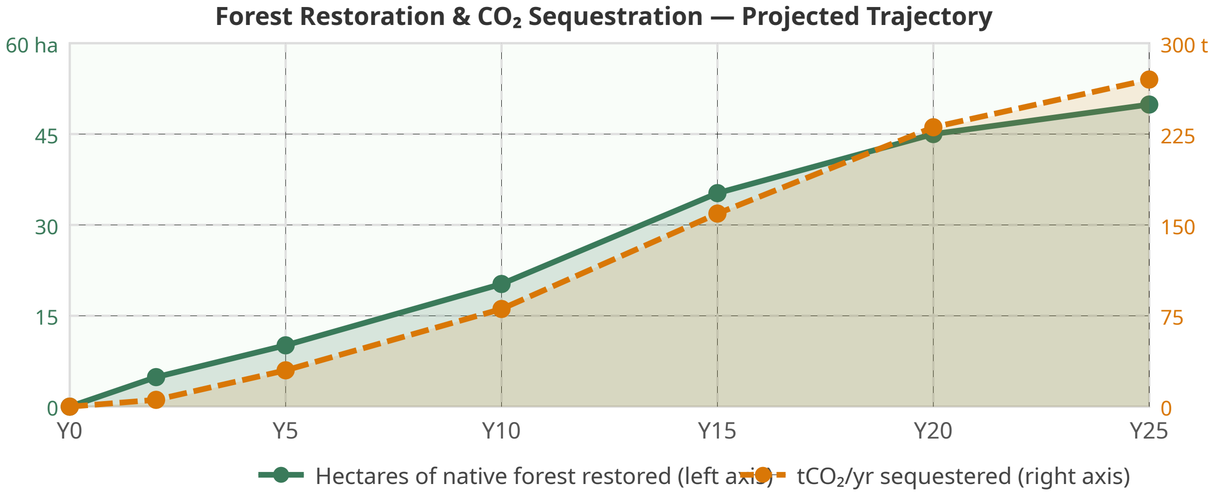


Projections — to be confirmed by Phase 1 feasibility study (Dec 2026)

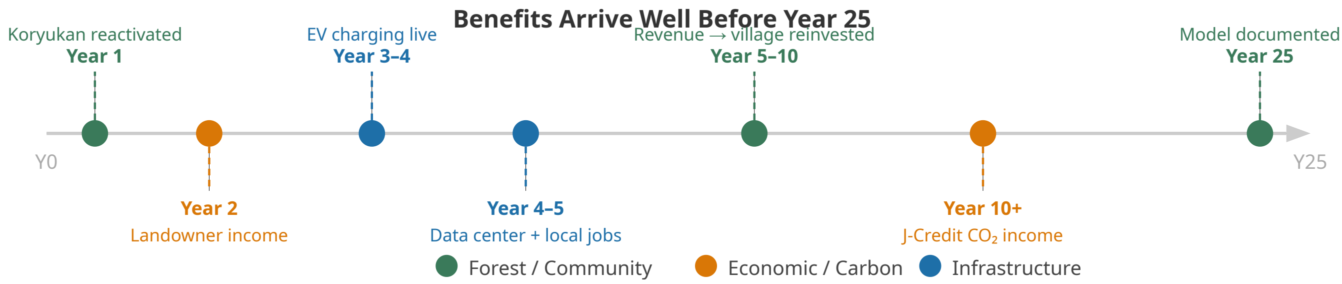
How We Will Know We Succeeded — in 10 Years

> "Our goal isn't to build one successful project — it's to create an open-source model that other rural communities in Japan can adopt."

By 2036, the Mitsue Project will have demonstrated success if:

- **20+ hectares** of native forest actively established and growing
- **Data center** operationally self-sustaining, generating net surplus reinvested into the village
- **8–15 local jobs** sustained (not one-time construction work)
- **CO_2 sequestration** verified and credited under J-Credit
- **At least 3 other communities** actively using the documented playbook
- **250M+ open data points** published — continuing the Safecast tradition of radical transparency

These are outcome metrics, not output metrics. They answer the question any impact investor would ask: *did the intervention change something durable?*



The Multiplier Hidden in the Model

Most rural revitalisation projects in Japan depend permanently on subsidy. This one is designed to become **financially self-sustaining within 10 years** — and then to fund further forest expansion and community investment from operating surplus.

The biomass circular economy is the key multiplier: thinning the forest earns landowners income, speeds ecological recovery, and generates the fuel that powers the village. The more you thin, the faster the native forest returns. Faster restoration means more J-Credit income. More J-Credit income means more thinning capacity. The loop accelerates itself.

The data center provides the anchor demand that makes the energy investment viable from day one — without it, a biomass CHP plant sized for a mountain village of 1,800 people would not close financially on its own.

What Philanthropy Unlocks

Phase	What Philanthropy Funds	What It Unlocks
Phase 0 (now–M9)	Feasibility studies, legal structure, community consultation	Government grant eligibility (MoE 交付金 covers 2/3–3/4 of Phase 1–2 energy capex)
Phase 1–2 (Y1–Y5)	Gap funding (¥28–53M remaining after government grants and corporate partners)	Data center live; biomass CHP installed; local jobs created; village self-sufficient in energy
Phase 3+ (Y5–Y25)	Replication documentation, open-data publishing, academic partnerships	Other rural communities in Japan adopt the model; global visibility for a working example

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Context: Why This Village, Why Now

Mitsue Village (御杖村), Nara Prefecture: population ~1,600, 88% forest cover, aging cedar monoculture that is both an ecological liability and an untapped energy resource. The village published Japan's national RE plan in January 2025 — making it eligible for the government's decarbonization funding ladder. A resident electrical engineer with a 13-year track record in the village and global open-science credentials (Safecast, 250M+ open measurements post-Fukushima) has the technical depth and the community trust to bridge these worlds.

The moment is now because the funding ladder requires an operating partner to qualify — and the village has completed Step 1 without one in place. Phase 0 closes that gap.

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mitsue.it

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